



President seeking to renovate arts venue

Donald Trump proposes a two-year closure for the Kennedy Center

BY JANAY KINGSBERRY AND TRAVIS M. ANDREWS

President Donald Trump said Sunday that he plans to close the Kennedy Center for roughly two years to undergo construction. The proposal comes amid a series of cancellations and internal upheaval since he took over the arts institution and presidential memorial nearly a year ago and remade it in his name and image. “I have determined that The

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Google’s AI said to have aided Israel militarily

Whistleblower claims company breached own ethics rules on weapons

BY GERRIT DE VYNCK

SAN FRANCISCO — Google breached its own policies that barred use of artificial intelligence for weapons or surveillance in 2024 by helping an Israeli military contractor analyze drone video footage, a former Google employee alleged in a confidential federal whistleblower complaint reviewed by The Washington Post.

Google’s Gemini AI technology was being used by Israel’s defense apparatus at a time that the company was publicly dis-

SEE GOOGLE ON A16

Trump lets jokes, jeers fly at elite dinner

President’s punch lines at times fall flat before Alfalfa Club members

BY MATT VISER

Over the past week, President Donald Trump’s government has presided over the arrest of a prominent journalist, invoked false claims of fraud to seize ballots in Georgia and defended the shooting death of another protester in Minneapolis by federal agents.

He’s also done this: attended a lavish screening of his wife Melania’s documentary film, fixated on construction projects includ-

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ED RAM/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Peter Shitanda Malalu and Evans Khagola hold photos of their cousin Oscar Khagola Mutoka, a Kenyan last heard from in June.

Russia lured Kenyans with job prospects, then forced them to Ukraine’s front lines

Hundreds of Kenyans have been recruited by the Russian military to serve on the front lines in Ukraine, according to former recruits and their families. Many have never returned.

Most men said they were tricked — offered civilian or “safe” security jobs in Russia, only to be handed a weapon and sent to the battlefield. Others were current or former soldiers who joined up as mercenaries, lured by promises of higher wages. The survivors described inhumane treatment by Russian commanders and harrowing scenes of slaughter.

While there have been isolated reports of Africans conscripted by Moscow to fight, The Washington Post uncovered an

Deceptive recruitment tactics are used across Africa, with survivors telling of inhumane treatment by commanders, harrowing scenes of slaughter

BY RAELOMBUOR AND KATHARINE HOURELD

extensive clandestine pipeline stretching from Nairobi to the forests of eastern Ukraine. Russian recruitment in Kenya is more widespread, and more deadly, than previously reported, and the effort extends across the continent. The Post spoke to recruits or their family members in South Africa, Botswana, Tanzania and Nigeria, and it heard anecdotal accounts of fighters in Ukraine from eight other African countries, including Ghana, Zimbabwe and Cameroon — hidden victims of the largest European conflict since World War II.

The phenomenon is driven by two converging forces: economic desperation in Kenya, pushing young men to pursue

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QUINN ROONEY/GETTY IMAGES

Isn’t life Grand?

Carlos Alcaraz becomes the youngest man to complete the career tennis Grand Slam by beating Novak Djokovic, 2-6, 6-2, 6-3, 7-5, to win the Australian Open in Melbourne on Sunday. C1

Minneapolis police chief negotiates federal surge

Brian O’Hara fears progress since murder of Floyd may unravel

BY MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE AND MARK BERMAN

MINNEAPOLIS — It was a brisk night last week when Brian O’Hara, the Minneapolis police chief, stood in front of his newest crop of officers and acknowledged the tough assignment ahead.

The Minneapolis police force had “faced extraordinary challenges,” O’Hara said. He did not list them, but people in the room and beyond knew: an officer murdering George Floyd in 2020, sparking unrest and damaging riots; plummeting morale; a flood of departures; and a federal investigation detailing rampant civil rights abuses.

“You will not receive deference

that other officers in other places automatically receive,” O’Hara told two dozen new officers, including police academy graduates and other hires, during a ceremony Wednesday evening in a Gothic downtown basilica. “Every day, you’re going to be expected to show up in a way that earns trust, to prove who you are.”

Outside, a mammoth immigration crackdown had flooded Minneapolis with several thousand federal officers, presenting O’Hara and his department with its biggest crisis since he took over in 2022.

O’Hara fears immigration agents’ tactics and behavior — including fatally shooting two people — could exacerbate residents’ lingering wariness of law enforcement, imperiling a years-long push to improve community relations.

But according to law enforcement

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U.S. mayors on edge: City leaders concerned after ICE shootings. A5

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Partial shutdown The Republican House speaker projected confidence that the government will be reopened by Tuesday. A3

THE NATION Democrats narrowed the GOP’s House majority with a win in Texas. A3

THE WORLD Persian Gulf states warn U.S. officials of Iran’s missile arsenal. A8

STYLE Courtney Love gets vulnerable about the highs and tragedies of her life in an intimate documentary aired at the Sundance festival. B1

THE REGION A one-man play tells of life with dementia. C7

HEALTH & SCIENCE Televised depictions of CPR are often flawed. D1

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